his
improvised
but
highly
reliable
telecommand system. Prof. Sarabhai did not take much time to back the young experimenter in preference to an established expert. Madhavan Nair not only lived up to the expectations of his leader but even went beyond them. He was to later become the project director of the Polar Satel ite Launch Vehicle (PSLV).

SLVs and missiles can be cal ed first cousins: they are different in concept and purpose, but come from the same bloodline of rocketry. A massive missile development project had been taken up by DRDO at the Defence Research & Development Laboratory (DRDL), Hyderabad. As the pace of this surface-to-air missile development project increased, the frequency of the Missile Panel meetings and my interaction with Gp Capt Narayanan also increased.

In 1968, Prof. Sarabhai came to Thumba on one of his routine visits. He was shown the operation of the nose-cone